WHITE PAPER · SAMSUNG SL-65A/3200 × MILITARY & DEFENSE

Samsung SL-65A for Military & Defense

Large-envelope CNC lathe with steady-rest support for precision turning of long, heavy structural round parts. This paper covers what the machine does, the military & defense parts we produce with it, the alloys we run, the tolerances and finishes military & defense buyers expect, and the documentation package.

22" OD × 119" L max turning (with steady rest) ENVELOPE	**±0.0005" routine on critical features** TOLERANCE
1994 SINCE	**Same-week / rig-down direct** RESPONSE

Big Thicket Express · 22" OD × 119" L max turning (with steady rest) · large-envelope heavy-duty CNC lathe with steady rest

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Executive summary

Machine: Samsung SL-65A/3200 (shop nickname: *Big Thicket Express*). large-envelope heavy-duty CNC lathe with steady rest at B&R Productions, running from our New Waverly, Texas shop.

Application: Large-envelope CNC lathe with steady-rest support for precision turning of long, heavy structural round parts for Military & Defense customers — Defense primes, subassembly manufacturers, tactical vehicle component OEMs, munitions component suppliers, weapon-system integrators, sustainment (out-of-production replacement) contractors.

Envelope: 22" OD × 119" L max turning (with steady rest). **Tolerance:** ±0.0005" routine on critical features. **Traceability:** Material by heat and lot on every job.

The machine, in context

This is the heaviest machine on the floor. When a customer sends a 20-inch forged blank and wants it turned to a finished OD with concentric internal features across ten feet of length, Big Thicket Express is the answer. The included steady rest is what makes long slender work possible — without it, deflection eats your tolerance.

Why Big Thicket Express for Defense work

The largest defense round work — heavy forged rounds, large housings, long heavy structural parts — at 22" OD × 119" L with steady-rest support. This is the machine for parts that other shops decline on size.

What this looks like on a real part

A large heavy forging that is also long is the case where the steady rest is the entire setup strategy. The rest has to bear on a turned, true, concentric journal — clamping it to as-received forged surface transfers that surface's runout directly into the finished diameter, and on a part with this much embedded value that mistake is expensive. Establish the journal, set the rest to it, then turn the part. In that order, every time.

> **When this is the wrong machine**
>
> Non-controlled work only. Heavy setup overhead makes small and mid-size defense work uneconomical here — those belong on a Hi-Eco cell.

Full specifications

Model	Samsung SL-65A/3200 ("Big Thicket Express")
Type	Large-envelope heavy-duty CNC turning center — Samsung SL-65A platform
Max turning capacity	22" OD × 119" L (B&R working spec, with steady rest)
Platform max swing	40.5" over bed
Platform max turning length	126" (3,200 mm) between centers
Chuck	24" hydraulic 3-jaw
Steady rest	Included — supports long slender work to hold straightness
Main motor	60 HP high-torque
Rigidity	Samsung SL-65 platform — heavy cast base for the largest oilfield turning work
Tolerance capability	±0.0005" routine on critical features; straightness held with steady-rest
Materials	Full range — forgings, bar stock, tubing in oilfield and structural alloys

Values marked "platform" reflect the machine manufacturer's published spec range for this platform family; B&R's working spec is what we quote on this specific unit.

Who this serves in Military & Defense

Typical buyer: Defense primes, subassembly manufacturers, tactical vehicle component OEMs, munitions component suppliers, weapon-system integrators, sustainment (out-of-production replacement) contractors.

What's hard about military & defense work: Sensitive prints, program-specific quality plans, tight-tolerance structural components, exotic-alloy selection driven by service environment, and legacy-part sustainment where the OEM no longer supports the design and the prime's supply chain has moved on.

Typical Military & Defense parts we produce on Big Thicket Express

- Largest-diameter defense turned work
- Long forged structural shafts
- Large actuator and cylinder bodies
- Heavy vehicle-scale structural components
- Extended defense-platform structural rods

Above list is representative; if your part isn't shown, call and ask — most oilfield / aerospace / defense / industrial turned or milled work fits somewhere in the shop.

Alloys we run for Military & Defense

Standard range: 17-4 PH · 15-5 PH · 13-8 Mo · 4140 pre-hard · 4340 · Titanium Grade 5 · Inconel 718 · Aluminum 7075 · High-strength steels · Customer-specific alloys on request.

Defense parts routinely spec 4140 pre-hard, 4340, and precipitation-hardening stainless — condition-specific machining knowledge matters, same as aerospace. Titanium is common on weight-critical structural components. Legacy sustainment often specifies materials nobody sees anywhere else; we work with the spec sheet you provide and validate machining strategy before we cut.

> **What "we run these weekly" means:** we stock or reliably source the common alloys in the industry's typical spec range. Sharp tooling, proven feeds and speeds, and process control specific to each alloy family. Your part is not the one we're experimenting on.

How we machine it — our 5-step process

This is the process B&R runs on every job, military & defense or otherwise. The specifics of feeds, speeds, and tooling shift by alloy and machine; the discipline is universal.

1. **Material verification.** Every job starts with material traceability. Heat and lot numbers documented against the mill test report. For customer-supplied material, we verify against the CofC before touching the stock.

2 **First-article layout.** Stock is measured and laid out before any cutting starts. Concentricity, roundness, and squareness of the starting material established; if the stock is out of tolerance we call the customer before wasting time on a bad blank.

3 **Roughing with process control for the alloy.** Feeds, speeds, and coolant strategy set for the specific alloy family — sharp coated carbide (or PCD for high-volume Ti Grade 5), positive rake, high-pressure through-tool coolant on 2507 and Inconel to control cutting temperature. Interrupted cuts get extra attention because they cycle heat into the workpiece.

4 **Finish pass to spec.** Finish pass with a fresh insert, controlled DOC, and measured surface-finish targets. Critical features (bore concentricity, seat grooves, sealing surfaces) are held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer.

5 **CMM verification + documentation.** Every critical dimension CMM-verified. First-article report generated. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, tell us with the RFQ and we'll be straight about what we can and can't produce in-house.

Tolerance and finish expectations in Military & Defense

±0.0005" routine on critical features. Tighter with proper setup and fixture. GD&T-driven tolerancing supported. CMM verification on first articles; customer-plan-driven measurement on production runs. Documentation the level a program office expects.

Documentation and quality workflow

Sensitive prints handled under NDA with document control — prints stay in-shop and aren't sent to outside vendors. First-article documentation standard. Material traceability by heat and lot on every job. Certificates of conformance with delivery. One thing we state plainly up front: B&R is not ITAR-registered with the U.S. State Department. If your print is ITAR-controlled, we are not the right shop and we'll tell you that on the first call. Non-controlled defense-adjacent work — commercial-spec components, sustainment parts, tooling, and fixtures — we quote all day.

Response time and emergency work

Program-driven schedules honored. Emergency component replacement supported for sustainment programs with established relationships. Legacy-part reverse-engineering supported for out-of-production sustainment.

How we compare

Compared to a large defense-prime captive shop: we're faster for one-offs, small runs, and legacy sustainment where the prime's supply chain has moved on. Compared to a lowest-bidder commodity shop: we understand the alloys, we document properly, and we don't guess at a condition-specific machining plan. Compared to an ITAR-registered shop: for controlled prints they win, because that's a State Department registration and we don't hold it. Know which bucket your part is in before you shop it — it saves everyone a wasted quote cycle.

Working with B&R Productions

New customer or existing, the process starts the same way: call (936) 291-7827 or send a print through the quote form. Prints are accepted as PDF, STEP, IGES, DWG, or DXF; if you only have a sample part, we reverse-engineer routinely. NDAs on request, and prints stay in-shop rather than going out to third-party vendors. Note for defense and aerospace buyers: B&R is not ITAR- or AS9100-registered, so export-controlled prints and AS9100 flow-down programs need a registered shop — we'll tell you that on the first call, not after the PO.

Quotes typically come back within 24 hours for standard work, same-day for repeat customers on stocked materials, and near-immediately by phone for emergency and rig-down situations. Lead times are quoted honestly — we don't promise Wednesday and deliver next month.

Frequently asked questions

8 questions covering the Samsung SL-65A platform and Military & Defense work. Also indexed as FAQ schema for AI answer engines.

What's the Samsung SL-65A's max turning capacity?

22" OD × 119" L is B&R's working spec (with steady rest). The platform max is 40.5" swing over bed × 126" (3,200 mm) between centers. This is the heaviest machine on our floor.

Does the SL-65A include a steady rest?

Yes. The steady rest is what makes long slender turning work possible on this envelope — without it, deflection eats your tolerance on any part longer than about 30 diameters.

What's the horsepower and chuck size?

60 HP high-torque main motor with a 24" hydraulic 3-jaw chuck. Heavy cast base for the largest oilfield turning work we take.

Do you handle ITAR-controlled defense work?

No — and we'd rather be the shop that tells you that up front. ITAR compliance is a registration with the U.S. State Department's DDTC, not a set of practices a shop can simply adopt, and B&R does not hold it. If your print is ITAR-controlled, you need a registered facility. What we do handle: non-controlled defense-adjacent work — commercial-spec components, legacy sustainment parts, tooling, fixtures, and reverse-engineered replacements for programs the OEM walked away from. Sensitive prints stay in-shop under NDA with document control, and first-article documentation and material traceability come standard.

What kind of defense-adjacent parts is this shop suited to?

Structural and mounting hardware, housings and enclosures, hydraulic components, ground-vehicle and equipment parts, tooling and fixtures, and reverse-engineered legacy parts for platforms the OEM no longer supports — all on non-export-controlled work. That's a description of what the equipment and the alloy experience suit, not a claim about specific programs. If you want to know whether we've run something like your part, ask and we'll tell you straight.

What alloys are typical for defense work at B&R?

17-4 PH, 15-5 PH, 4140 pre-hard, 4340, Titanium Grade 5, Inconel 718, aluminum 7075, high-strength steels. Customer-specific alloys on request.

Can you reverse-engineer legacy defense parts?

Yes — sustainment work for out-of-production programs is a regular part of our mix. Send a worn sample and any documentation available; we'll produce the replacement with full material traceability.

What tolerances do you hold on defense components?

±0.0005" routine on critical features. Tighter with the right fixture. Every critical dimension CMM-verified. Documentation to customer spec.

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Ready to talk about your Military & Defense work?

Send us a print or a sample photo and specs. Emergencies: call direct and say "rig-down."

Published by B&R Productions — a precision CNC machining shop in New Waverly, Texas, in business since 1994. Serving oil & gas, aerospace, defense, and industrial customers across Texas and the Gulf Coast.

Written by the B&R Productions team. Machine specs verified against manufacturer data. Alloy and process notes reflect shop practice as of 2026-01-15.